

IT IS TIME TO WORSHIP

TEXT: Matthew 21:1-11(NKJV) *“As they approached Jerusalem and came to Bethphage on the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples, saying to them, “Go to the village ahead of you, and at once you will find a donkey tied there, with her colt by her. Untie them and bring them to me. If anyone says anything to you, tell him that the Lord needs them, and he will send them right away.” This took place to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet: “Say to the Daughter of Zion, ‘See, your king comes to you, gentle and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.’ ” The disciples went and did as Jesus had instructed them. They brought the donkey and the colt, placed their cloaks on them, and Jesus sat on them. A very large crowd spread their cloaks on the road, while others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road. The crowds that went ahead of him and those that followed shouted, “Hosanna to the Son of*

David!” “Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!” “Hosanna in the highest!”
When Jesus entered Jerusalem, the whole city was stirred and asked, “Who is this?” The crowds answered, “This is Jesus, the prophet from Nazareth in Galilee.”

INTRO: The first Palm Sunday was a grand event. A week later, things were not so good.

The day of the Triumphal Entry was punctuated with shouts of Hosanna! Hosanna means “*Save us now.*” The people who were lining the streets had no doubt witnessed the many miracles of Jesus and decided that He was the King who had come to save them, and they wanted Him to set up an earthly Kingdom then and there!

The scene was like a Super Bowl champion parade on steroids! The people were not only worshipping Him with their voices, but they were waving palm branches and throwing foliage in the streets ahead of him.

Unfortunately, in only a few days the chorus changed to “***Crucify Him!***” My, how things change! Human flesh is fickle! The very people who were crying “***Hosanna***” were screaming, “***Crucify Him***” a few days later. How could this be?

The people had selfish expectations of Jesus and when He failed to meet those expectations, they abandoned Him in the most violent way imaginable. What are your expectations of Him and what would make you walk away from Him?

- Will you walk away as the result of the loss of a relationship?
- Will you walk away from Him because of the death of a family member?
- Will you forsake Him because of a financial reversal?
- Will you walk away from Him as the result of a pandemic?

We see walking away from Him and crying “*Crucify Him*” as two different things, but actually, they are one and the same!

A time of crisis should drive us to:

- Lift Him up rather than Leave Him...
- Magnify Him rather than malign Him...
- Praise Him rather than part ways with Him...
- Worship Him rather than withdraw from Him...

We are walking through a time right now where we are experiencing uncertainty at every level. How should we handle this? I say it is time to worship!

WORSHIP IS FOR GOOD TIMES

Not everyone will, but anyone could, worship Him in the good times. Oddly enough, when things are going good we have a propensity to worship our own success rather than worshipping God. We have recently become

painfully aware that EVERYTHING can change overnight!

We are to not only worship God in the good times, but we are to live in a constant state of worship. If you are looking for a reason to worship I remind you of 1 Peter 2:9 (NKJV)

“But you are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, His own special people, that you may proclaim the praises of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.”

We should live in a state of worship because God happens to live in an atmosphere of worship. Psalm 22 says that ***“God is enthroned in the praises of His people.”*** Just as the people on that first Palm Sunday worshipped with their words and actions, we should worship Him.

When things are going well – It is time to worship the Lord!

WORSHIP IS FOR BAD TIMES

As it relates to the people on that first Palm Sunday, things were as good as they could be, and they worshipped without any thought of who was watching, or what was happening around them.

One-week later things were as bad as they could get, and the very people who were saying *“Hosana, blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord,”* were crying *“Crucify Him!”*

Today, all of us are painfully aware of how quickly things can change. In times like these we must remember that worship is not just for good times, it is also for bad times.

Worship is a jamming device God has provided for us to use on the best plan hell has concocted against us. When the devil throws the very best he has at us, and we start worshipping, we throw hell into a state of panic and confusion!

Are we using this weapon? Are we using it to its maximum potential?

Things are not the best right now, but this I can tell you, the person who can worship in the bad times will still be standing when the next shift happens!

As we see in the example of the people on that first Palm Sunday, those who can't worship in bad times, will be on the wrong side of the issue when the turnaround (Resurrection) occurs.

When things are not going well – It is time to worship the lord!

WE MUST WORSHIP OUR WAY THROUGH

Not very many who were in the crowd of worshippers on that first Palm Sunday were in the crowd on Resurrection Sunday! Who were the ones present at both? Those who worshipped their way through!

- Mary...
- Her friends...
- The Angel...
- Jesus...

So, we are living in difficult times! I want to know who intends to worship their way THROUGH?

- If the stimulus isn't enough, can we worship our way THROUGH?
- If our jobs don't call us back, can we worship our way THROUGH?
- If the stock market doesn't recover, can we worship our way THROUGH?
- If our new normal isn't anything like our old normal, can we worship our way THROUGH?

CONCLUSION:

- Job worshipped his way THROUGH!
- Daniel worshipped His way THROUGH!

- The three Hebrew Children worshipped their way THROUGH!
- Paul and Silas worshipped their way THROUGH!
- John the Revelator worshipped his way off of Patmos!

Will we worship our way THROUGH? Let's turn this Palm Sunday into a worship fest that will take us through Resurrection Sunday and beyond!